

AMELIA REESE MASTERSON, MPH

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EDUCATION

- UCLA Fielding School of Public Health, Los Angeles, CA **Expected Graduation: June 2027**
Doctoral Student (PhD)
Department of Community Health Sciences
Dissertation Title: *Exclusionary Policy, Migration Stressors, and Women's Health among Refugees and Asylees Entering California from 2014 to 2025.*
- Yale School of Public Health, New Haven, CT **May 2013**
Master of Public Health (MPH)
Department of Chronic Disease Epidemiology, Global Health Concentration
- Gordon College, Wenham, MA **May 2007**
Bachelor of Arts (BA) in Political Studies

RELEVANT RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

- Cottage Health, Santa Barbara, CA** **Jun. 2021-Present**
Co-Principal Investigator, Evaluator, Population Health
- Serve as co-PI on the *Maternal Health Equity Study*, a multi-method study of person-centered maternity care and pregnancy and birth outcomes
 - Design and implement rigorous evaluation across all Population Health programs, including community health worker programs, social needs screening and referral programs, community nursing programs, and hospital-based quality initiatives
- Global Women's Institute, George Washington University, DC and Lebanon** **Feb. 2019-Sep. 2021**
Research Consultant, *Empowered Aid Participatory Action Research Study*
- Provided research technical support to multi-year research project on prevention of sexual exploitation and abuse among refugee women and girl aid recipients in Lebanon and Uganda
 - Led capacity building at CARE International in participatory action research, implementation research, quantitative and qualitative methods, sexual and reproductive health, and GBV
- Community Alliance for Research & Engagement, New Haven, CT** **Feb. 2020-Jun. 2021**
Research Consultant, *Racial & Ethnic Approaches to Community Health Grant (CDC)*
- Led research and evaluation of maternal health equity and breastfeeding support activities
 - Launched and coordinated city task force to address racial/ethnic disparities in breastfeeding
 - Conducted outreach and advocacy to launch public lactation spaces, state-wide breastfeeding friendly clinic and business designations, and a city-wide messaging campaign
 - Coordinated physician training in culturally relevant breastfeeding support
- International Medical Corps, Washington, DC, and Beirut, Lebanon** **Nov. 2014-Dec. 2016**
Research Advisor, *Nutrition, Food Security & Livelihoods Unit (NFSL)*
- Developed research strategy and portfolio for NFSL and the Technical Unit
 - Designed and ran quantitative and qualitative program-based research across 11 countries
 - Conducted training and capacity building for staff worldwide on research methods
 - Analyzed data and disseminated results through reports, articles, and presentations

American University of Beirut (AUB), Lebanon**Sep. 2013-Oct. 2014**Research Fellow, *Center for Research on Population and Health*

- Served as researcher on cluster-randomized controlled trial (*Healthy Kitchens, Healthy Children*) of an innovative school feeding model in UNRWA school system in Beirut, Lebanon
- Managed research staff and trainings throughout project, primarily in Arabic
- Contributed to study design, data collection, analysis, and writing of reports and articles

United Nations Population Fund (UNFPA), Beirut, Lebanon**May-Aug. 2012, Mar.-Aug. 2014**Research Consultant, *Assessment of Reproductive Health and GBV*

- Served as Co-Primary Investigator on multi-method assessment of reproductive health and gender-based violence among Syrian refugee women in Lebanon

Research Consultant, *Assessment of Sexual and Gender Based Violence (SGBV) Referral Network*

- Designed and ran qualitative assessment of SGBV Referral Network and UNFPA's Life Skills/Empowerment Program for Syrian refugees in Lebanon

Tufts Friedman School of Nutrition Science and Policy, Boston, MA**Oct. 2009-Jun. 2011**Research Coordinator, *USAID Food Aid Quality Review*

- Carried out survey across 42 countries on the use of US food aid
- Coordinated international research workshops on improvement of US food aid
- Managed budget and all financial and grant reporting and contributed to peer-reviewed articles
- Supervised research assistants, data collectors, and data analysts

United Nations Children's Fund (UNICEF), Damascus, Syria**Aug. 2007-Jul. 2008**Consultant, *Humanitarian Support Program for Iraqi Refugees*

- Conducted monitoring and reporting for Iraqi refugee child nutrition and education programs
- Partnered with the World Food Program to conduct nationwide survey of Iraqi refugees

RESEARCH GRANTS AND PROJECTS

UCLA Graduate Research Mentorship (PI: Reese Masterson)

2025

University of California Los Angeles

\$20,000

Do Exclusionary Migration Policies Impact Preconception Health? Evidence from California Refugee Health Surveillance Data, 2014-2023

Role: Principal Investigator

Mentor: Hiram Beltrán-Sánchez (UCLA)

Cottage Center for Population Health (Co-PI: Reese Masterson)

2025***Maternal Health Equity Study: Person-Centered Maternity Care and Birth Outcomes among Patients Delivering in a Hospital Setting***

Role: Co-Principal Investigator

UCLA Graduate Research Mentorship (PI: Reese Masterson)

2024

University of California Los Angeles

\$20,000

Immigrant Women's Employment Exclusions, Health Outcomes, and the Moderating Role of Social Cohesion Utilizing RIGHTS Data

Role: Principal Investigator

Mentor: May Sudhinaret (UCLA)

UCLA Graduate Summer Research Mentorship (PI: Reese Masterson)	2023
University of California Los Angeles	\$6,000
CenCal Health Sponsorship (further support for associated research costs)	\$5,000

Framing Migrant Farmworker Reproductive Health Risk: Inclusive Policy, Exclusive Structures in the State of California

Role: Principal Investigator

Mentor: May Sudhinaraset (UCLA)

Okvuran Fellowship for International Support (Co-PI: Reese Masterson)	2012
Yale School of Public Health	\$6,000

Reproductive Health and Gender Based Violence among Syrian Refugee Women

Role: Co-Principal Investigator

Mentor: Adrienne Ettinger (Yale School of Public Health)

HONORS, AWARDS, AND FELLOWSHIPS

University of California Los Angeles

Maternal and Child Health Epidemiology Fellowship (\$7000)	2023-2025
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- Awarded through the Maternal and Child Health Center of Excellence

The Graduate Council Diversity Fellowship (\$30,000 + tuition and fee coverage)	2023-2024
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- Awarded to graduate students who exemplify values of diversity in their academic, professional, and service activities

The Bixby Doctoral Fellowship (\$23,000)	2022-2024
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- Awarded by the Bixby Center on Population and Reproductive Health

UCLA Graduate Division Award (\$14,136 in tuition and fee coverage)	2022-2023
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The Women's Impact Alliance

The Coaching Fellowship (\$5000 value)	2017-2018
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- Awarded to women leaders in the social impact sector to support coaching in leadership development

Yale University

Gruber Fellowship for Global Justice & Women's Rights (\$44,000)	2013-2014
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- Post-graduate fellowship awarded by Yale Law School to support recent graduates to spend a year working on an issue of relevance to the fields of global justice and women's rights

Lowell Levin Award for Excellence in Global Health (\$500)	2013
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- Awarded for best global health master's thesis at Yale School of Public Health

Middlebury Arabic Language School

Kathryn Davis Fellowship for Peace (\$10,000)	2011
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- Merit-based award to support language study and promote intercultural understanding

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

1. Frieson T, **Reese Masterson A**, Tran V, Douglass F, O'Connor Duffany K. "Listening to Community to Improve Breastfeeding Friendliness: Findings From a Community Readiness Assessment on Breastfeeding," *Health Promotion Practice* 2025;0(0). doi:10.1177/15248399251362887.
2. Tran V, **Reese Masterson A**, Frieson T, Douglass F, Pérez-Escamilla P, O'Connor Duffany K. "Barriers and Facilitators to Exclusive Breastfeeding Among Black Mothers: A Qualitative Study Utilizing a Modified Barrier Analysis Approach in New Haven, CT," *Maternal and Child Nutrition* 2022; e13428.
3. Jamaluddine Z, Choufani J, **Reese Masterson A**, Hoteit R, Sahyoun NR, and Ghattas H. "A Community-Based School Nutrition Intervention Improves Diet Diversity and School Attendance in Palestinian Refugee Schoolchildren in Lebanon," *Current Developments in Nutrition* 2020; 4:11.
4. Ghattas H, Choufani J, Jamaluddine Z, **Reese Masterson A**, and Sahyoun NR. "Linking women-led community kitchens to school food programmes: lessons learned from the Healthy Kitchens, Healthy Children intervention in Palestinian refugee camps in Lebanon," *Public Health Nutrition* 2020; 23:5.
5. Sahyoun NR, Jamaluddine Z, Choufani J, Mesmar S, **Reese Masterson A**, and Ghattas H. "A mixed-methods evaluation of community-based healthy kitchens as social enterprises for refugee women," *BMC Public Health* 2019; 19:1590.
6. Usta J, **Reese Masterson A**, and Farver J. "Violence Against Displaced Syrian Women in Lebanon," *Journal of Interpersonal Violence* 2019; Sep; 34(18):3767-3779.
7. DeJong J, Ghattas H, Bashour H, Mourtada R, Akik C, and **Reese Masterson A**. "Reproductive, Maternal, Neonatal and Child Health in Conflict: A Case Study on Syria Using Countdown Indicators," *BMJ Global Health* 2017; 2: e000302. doi:10.1136/bmjgh-2017-000302.
8. **Reese Masterson A**, Gupta J, Usta J, Ettinger AS. "Assessment of Reproductive Health and Violence Against Women Among Displaced Syrians in Lebanon," *BMC Women's Health* 2014; 14:25.
9. Lippitt M, **Reese Masterson A**, Sierra A, Davis A, White MA. "An Exploration of Social Desirability Bias in Measurement of Attitudes Toward Breastfeeding in Public," *Journal of Human Lactation* 2014; 30(3):358-366.
10. Jack H, **Reese Masterson A**, Khoshnood K. "Violent conflict and opiate use in low and middle-income countries: A systematic review," *International Journal of Drug Policy* 2013; Nov. 20 [Epub ahead of print].
11. Rogers B, Webb P, Wanke C, Sadler K, **Reese Masterson A**, Bagriansky J, Schlossman N, Narayan A, Tilahun J. "Selection and use of US Title II food aid products in programming contexts," *Food and Nutrition Bulletin* 2011; 32(3): 152S-165S(14).
12. Rosenberg I, Tilahun J, Schlossman N, Bagriansky J, Johnson Q, Webb P, Rogers B, **Reese Masterson A**. "Nutritional enhancement of US Title II food aid products," *Food and Nutrition Bulletin* 2011; 32(3): 134S-151S(18).

13. Schlossman N, Webb P, Bagriansky J, Johnson Q, Rogers B, Tilahun J, **Reese Masterson A**. "Enhancing processes for introduction, production, quality assurance, and delivery of US Title II food aid products," *Food and Nutrition Bulletin* 2011; 32(3): 166S-171S(6).

MANUSCRIPTS UNDER REVIEW OR IN PROGRESS

1. **Reese Masterson A**, Lintz K, Beck D. "Evaluating COVID-Era High-Wage-Replacement Paid Parental Leave Policies: Maternal Health Outcomes Among Low-Income Populations in Two States." *Manuscript under review*.
2. **Reese Masterson A**, Maldonado A. "California's Growing Female Migrant Farmworker Population: Structural Vulnerability, Reproductive Rights, and State Services Access During the Perinatal Period." *Manuscript in preparation*.

OTHER PUBLICATIONS

1. **Reese Masterson A**, Lopez S, Garcia G, Maldonado A, Smith M, Sudhinaraset M. "Maternal Health Rights for Farmworker Women: Farmworker Voices from the Field," Evaluation Report, November 2023 (https://ucghi.universityofcalifornia.edu/news/maternal-health-rights-farmworker-women-teaching-and-research-action/farmworker_maternal_health_and_rights_evaluation_report_november_2023.pdf).
2. Potts A, Fattal L, Hedge E, Hallak F, and **Reese Masterson A**. "Empowered Aid: Participatory Action Research with Refugee Women & Girls to Better Prevent Sexual Exploitation and Abuse—Lebanon Results Report," Washington, DC: The George Washington University and Lebanon: CARE International; 2020 (<https://globalwomensinstitute.gwu.edu/empowered-aid-resources>).
3. Ghattas H, Jamaluddine Z, Choufani J, **Reese Masterson A**, and Sahyoun N. "Improvements in economic, social, and food security outcomes of Palestinian refugee women and diet diversity of Palestinian schoolchildren in Lebanon: the Healthy Kitchens, Healthy Children intervention," *The Lancet* 2019; 31:S25.
4. Ghattas H, Jamaluddine Z, Choufani J, Btaiche R, **Reese Masterson A**, and Sahyoun N. "A Community-Based Intervention Improves Economic, Social and Food Security Outcomes of Refugee Women— The Healthy Kitchens Experience," *The FASEB Journal* 2017; 31:1S.
5. **Reese Masterson A**, Maehara M, and Gathii M. "Stunting and Wasting in Children Under Two Years Old in a Semi-Nomadic Pastoralist Population in Kenya," *Field Exchange* 52, May 2016.
6. **Reese Masterson A** and Murakwani P. "Assessment of Adolescent Girl Nutrition, Dietary Practices and Roles in Zimbabwe," *Field Exchange* 52, May 2016.
7. Mbura D, Chiedo C, Mutea F, and **Reese Masterson A**. "Improving Food and Nutrition Security for Households with Underweight Children in Taita Taveta County, Kenya," *Field Exchange* 51, January 2016. p 111.
8. **Reese Masterson A**, Ghattas H, Fouad MF. "The Potential Role of Local Academia in Protracted Crises: The Example of the American University of Beirut," *Field Exchange* 2015; 48:61.

9. Usta J and **Reese Masterson A**. "Women and Health in Refugee Settings: The Case of Displaced Syrian Women in Lebanon," in Gender-Based Violence – Perspectives from Africa, the Middle East, and India, eds. Kimuna S, Djamba Y. Springer International: 2015.
10. **Reese Masterson A**, Sipsma H, and Bradley E. "The nutrition transition in Egypt: the double burden of over- and undernutrition at the household level examining mother-child pairs," The FASEB Journal 2013 27:S1.

CONFERENCES AND PRESENTATIONS

Population Association of America, St. Louis, MO	April 2026
Presentation: "Evaluating COVID-Era High-Wage-Replacement Paid Parental Leave Policies: Maternal Health Outcomes Among Low-Income Populations in Two States"	
Psychosocial Workshop, Pre-Meeting at Population Association of America, St. Louis, MO	April 2026
Presentation: "Migration Stressors and Preconception Health among Women Seeking Humanitarian Protection in the U.S."	
Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management (APPAM), Seattle, WA	November 2025
Presentation: "Evaluating COVID-Era High Wage Replacement Paid Parental Leave Policies: Maternal Health Outcomes Among Low-Income Populations in Two States"	
Psychosocial Workshop, Pre-Meeting at Population Association of America, Columbus, OH	April 2024
Presentation: "Framing Migrant Farmworker Reproductive Risk: Inclusive Policies, Exclusive Structures in the state of California"	
Vizient Connections Summit, Las Vegas, NV	August 2023
Presentation: "Developing a Spanish-Language Virtual Care Model to Improve Health Equity"	
Accelerating Health Equity Conference, American Hospital Association, Cleveland, OH	May 2022
Presentation: "Starting at Home: Addressing the Social Determinants of Health in the Workforce"	
Yale School of Public Health Leadership Council, Annual Meeting, New York, NY	November 2017
Presentation: "CitySeed and the Importance of Food Security Work in New Haven"	
Core Group – Nutrition, Annual Meeting, Washington, DC	Oct. 2015
Presentation: "Risk Factors for Stunting and Wasting Among Semi-Nomadic Pastoralists in Kenya"	
Optimal Pregnancy Environmental Risk Assessment, PREBIC, San Francisco, CA	March 2015
Presentation: "Refugees and Victims of Violence" (http://operamtg.org/presentations/)	
North American Refugee Health Conference, Toronto, Canada	June 2013
Presentation: "Reproductive Health and Gender-Based Violence Among Syrian Refugees in Lebanon"	
American Society for Nutrition, Annual Meeting, Boston, MA	April 2013
Poster presentation: "The Nutrition Transition in Egypt: The Double Burden of Over- and Under-Nutrition at the Household Level in Mother-Child Pairs"	

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

University of California Santa Barbara, CA

INT187 *Community-based Participatory Research for Health and Social Justice*, **Guest Lecturer**

- Led a 40-minute lecture and discussion on “Ethical Considerations in CBPR” Spring 2023

INT187 *Community-based Participatory Research for Health and Social Justice*, **Guest Lecturer**

- Led a 40-minute lecture and discussion on “Ethical Considerations in CBPR” Spring 2022

Yale School of Public Health, New Haven, CT

CDE *Chronic Disease Epidemiology Seminar*, **Guest Lecturer**

Fall 2019

- Presented 40-minute lecture on “From Food Access to Food Justice: Building an Equitable Community Food System”

EPH 542b *Community Health Planning*, **Teaching Assistant**

Spring 2013

- Supported instruction in 2-hour graduate level epidemiology course on planning and designing public health programs, including a practicum assignment with a local agency
- Supported student teams to provide program-relevant research and action report

CDE 543 *Global Aspects of Food and Nutrition*, **Teaching Assistant & Guest Lecturer**

Fall 2012

- Supported instruction in 3-hour graduate-level epidemiology course on conditions leading to malnutrition and current best practices in interventions to prevent and address malnutrition
- Presented 40-minute lecture on “Emergency Nutrition”

SKILLS AND AFFILIATIONS

Student Affiliate, California Center for Population Research (CCPR), UCLA

Visiting Scholar, Broom Center for Demography, University of California Santa Barbara

Member, Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management (APPAM)

Member, Population Association of America (PAA)

Software: R, Stata, SPSS, SAS, NVivo, Dedoose, PowerBI, Epic, REDCap, Qualtrics, ODK

Languages: English (native), Levantine Arabic (advanced), Spanish (intermediate)